

Saviynt Basics

Topic	Interview Definition
IGA (Identity Governance and Administration)	Manages user identities, access, provisioning, certifications, and compliance across enterprise applications.
IAM (Identity and Access Management)	Ensures the right users have the right access to the right resources at the right time. IGA is a subset of IAM focused on governance.
Identity	A digital representation of a person (employee, contractor, vendor, etc.) in Saviynt containing user attributes and access information.
Account	A user account in a target application (e.g., Active Directory, SAP, Salesforce) associated with an identity. One identity can have multiple accounts.
Entitlement	A permission, privilege, group, or role within an application that grants specific access.
Role	A collection of entitlements assigned together based on a user's job function. Simplifies access management.
Birthright Access	Access automatically assigned to a user based on attributes like department, location, or job title during onboarding.
Requestable Access	Access that is not automatically assigned but can be requested by a user through the Access Request System.
Application	Any connected or disconnected system managed by Saviynt, such as SAP, Active Directory, Salesforce, or Workday.
Endpoint	The connection object representing an application in Saviynt, including connector configuration and synchronization details.
Resource	Any object that users can access, such as applications, roles, entitlements, groups, or accounts.
Organization	A logical grouping of users or resources used for management, reporting, or governance purposes.

Identity Repository	The central database in Saviynt where identities, accounts, entitlements, roles, and access information are stored.
Identity Warehouse	A centralized repository that consolidates identity and access data from multiple systems for governance and reporting.
Identity Lifecycle	The complete lifecycle of a user: Joiner → Mover → Leaver, including onboarding, access changes, and deprovisioning.
Governance	Processes that ensure access is appropriate, compliant, reviewed, and follows organizational policies.
Compliance	Meeting internal policies and external regulations (e.g., SOX, HIPAA, GDPR) through proper identity governance.
Audit	Reviewing logs, reports, certifications, and access history to verify compliance and detect unauthorized access.
Risk	The potential security or compliance issue caused by excessive, inappropriate, or conflicting access.
SoD (Segregation of Duties)	Prevents users from having conflicting permissions that could enable fraud (e.g., creating and approving the same payment).
Access Certification	A periodic review where managers or application owners approve, revoke, or modify users' access.
Provisioning	The automated process of granting or modifying user accounts and entitlements in target systems.
Deprovisioning	The automated removal or disabling of user access when it is no longer required, such as when an employee leaves.
Reconciliation	The process of importing accounts and entitlements from target systems into Saviynt to keep identity data synchronized.

Architecture

Topic	Interview Definition
Saviynt Architecture	The overall design of Saviynt consisting of the UI, application layer, database, connectors, job scheduler, and target applications. It manages identity governance, provisioning, and compliance.
Database Schema	The logical structure of Saviynt's database that stores identities, accounts, applications, roles, entitlements, requests, tasks, certifications, and audit information in related tables.
ECM (Enterprise Identity Cloud Management)	Saviynt's cloud-based Identity Governance platform that provides identity lifecycle management, access governance, provisioning, certifications, analytics, and compliance.
REST API	A set of HTTP-based APIs used to integrate Saviynt with external systems for importing users, managing access requests, provisioning, reporting, and automation.
Connectors	Integration components that allow Saviynt to communicate with target systems (e.g., Active Directory, SAP, Salesforce) for importing accounts and provisioning access.
Identity Repository	The central database in Saviynt where identities, accounts, entitlements, roles, and access information are stored.
Microservices	An architecture where Saviynt services are divided into independent components that perform specific functions such as provisioning, analytics, and notifications. This improves scalability and reliability.
Job Scheduler	A service that automatically executes scheduled jobs such as user imports, account imports, provisioning tasks, reconciliation, certifications, and reports.
Queue	A holding area where provisioning tasks or background jobs wait until they are processed by the job scheduler or task engine.
Vault	A secure storage location used to protect sensitive information such as connector passwords, API credentials, certificates, and encryption keys.
Encryption	A security mechanism that converts sensitive data into an unreadable format to protect passwords, credentials, and confidential information stored or transmitted by Saviynt.

Authentication & SSO

Topic	Interview Definition
Authentication	The process of verifying a user's identity using credentials such as a username, password, OTP, biometric, or certificate. It answers "Who are you?"
Authorization	The process of determining what an authenticated user is allowed to access or perform. It answers "What are you allowed to do?"
SSO (Single Sign-On)	An authentication method that allows users to log in once and access multiple applications without signing in again.
Okta	A cloud-based Identity Provider (IdP) that manages user authentication, Single Sign-On (SSO), Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), and lifecycle management. Saviynt commonly integrates with Okta for authentication.
SAML (Security Assertion Markup Language)	An XML-based standard used to exchange authentication and authorization data between an Identity Provider (IdP) and a Service Provider (SP) to enable Single Sign-On.
OAuth	An authorization framework that allows third-party applications to access user resources without sharing the user's password by using access tokens.
OpenID Connect (OIDC)	An authentication protocol built on top of OAuth 2.0 that verifies a user's identity and provides user profile information using ID tokens.
MFA (Multi-Factor Authentication)	A security mechanism that requires users to provide two or more verification factors (password, OTP, fingerprint, etc.) before granting access.
Pass-through Authentication	An authentication method where Saviynt forwards the user's login request to an external authentication system (such as Active Directory or Okta) instead of validating the credentials itself.
LDAP (Lightweight Directory Access Protocol)	A protocol used to access and manage directory services like Active Directory. It is commonly used for user authentication and directory lookups.

Active Directory (AD)

Microsoft's directory service that stores users, groups, computers, organizational units, and authentication information. It is widely used for Windows authentication and access management.

Azure AD (Microsoft Entra ID)

Microsoft's cloud-based identity and access management service that provides authentication, SSO, MFA, application integration, and identity management for cloud applications.

SAV Roles

Topic	Interview Definition
SAV Role	A predefined administrative role in Saviynt that determines what actions a user can perform within the Saviynt application. It controls access to menus, pages, and administrative functions.
Custom SAV Role	A user-defined administrative role created by combining specific permissions based on business requirements. It follows the principle of least privilege by granting only the required administrative access.
Role Assignment	The process of assigning a SAV Role to a user so they can perform specific administrative functions within Saviynt. Roles can be assigned manually or through policies/workflows.
Role Hierarchy	A structured relationship where higher-level roles inherit permissions from lower-level roles, making administration easier and reducing duplicate permission assignments.
Role Delegation	The temporary assignment of a user's administrative responsibilities or approvals to another user during absence, vacation, or leave.
Admin Role	A SAV Role with administrative privileges, such as managing users, applications, roles, workflows, certifications, or system configurations. The level of access depends on the permissions assigned.
User Role	A business or application role assigned to end users to grant application access or entitlements. Unlike SAV Roles, User Roles do not provide administrative access to the Saviynt portal.

Certificates

Topic	Interview Definition
Certificate	A digital document used to verify the identity of a server, application, or user. It contains a public key and is issued by a trusted Certificate Authority (CA) to enable secure communication.
SSL (Secure Sockets Layer) / TLS (Transport Layer Security)	A security protocol used to encrypt communication between systems. Although SSL is the older term, modern systems use TLS. In interviews, SSL usually refers to secure encrypted communication.
Keystore	A secure file that stores an application's private keys and its own certificates. Saviynt uses the keystore when it needs to authenticate itself to another system.
Truststore	A secure file that stores trusted CA certificates or server certificates. Saviynt checks the truststore to verify that the certificate presented by another system is trusted.
Key Pair	A pair of cryptographic keys consisting of a Public Key and a Private Key . The public key is shared, while the private key is kept secret. Together they enable encryption and digital signatures.
Certificate Import	The process of importing a server or CA certificate into Saviynt's truststore or keystore so secure SSL/TLS communication can be established with external systems.

Identity Management

Topic	Interview Definition
Identity Management	The process of creating, updating, managing, and removing user identities and their access throughout the employee lifecycle (Joiner, Mover, Leaver).
HRMS (Human Resource Management System)	The authoritative source (source of truth) for employee information such as name, employee ID, department, manager, job title, and location. Examples include Workday and SAP SuccessFactors.
Workday	A cloud-based HRMS commonly integrated with Saviynt to import employee data and trigger identity lifecycle events like onboarding, transfers, and termination.
HR Import	The process of importing employee data from the HRMS into Saviynt to create or update identities.
Identity Creation	The process of creating a new identity in Saviynt after importing employee information from the HRMS.
User Import	A job that imports user (identity) information from HRMS or other authoritative sources into Saviynt.
Account Import	A job that imports user accounts from target applications (such as AD, SAP, Salesforce) into Saviynt.
Incremental Import	Imports only the records that have changed since the last successful import. It is faster and commonly used for daily synchronization.
Full Import	Imports all records from the source system regardless of whether they have changed. It is usually performed during initial setup or major synchronization.
Identity Update	The process of updating an existing identity when employee information changes, such as department, manager, or job title.
Identity Refresh	A process that recalculates identities, roles, policies, and access after changes to user attributes, rules, or applications.
Correlation	The process of matching imported application accounts with the correct identity in Saviynt using unique attributes such as Employee ID or Email ID.

Account Matching	Comparing imported accounts with existing identities to determine which account belongs to which user before correlation is completed.
Account Linking	Associating a correlated application account with its corresponding identity in Saviynt. One identity can be linked to multiple accounts.
Account Merge	Combining duplicate accounts or duplicate identity records into a single logical identity to avoid duplication and maintain accurate governance.
Account Mapping	Defining how application accounts are associated with identities based on mapping rules such as Employee ID, Username, or Email Address.
Identity Attributes	Information that describes an identity, such as Employee ID, Username, Department, Manager, Job Title, Location, Email, and Status.
Attribute Mapping	Mapping fields from the source system (HRMS or application) to the corresponding identity attributes in Saviynt.

Applications

Topic	Interview Definition
Application	Any business system or software managed by Saviynt for identity governance and access management. Examples include Active Directory, SAP, Salesforce, ServiceNow, Oracle, and Workday.
Connected Application	An application that has a direct integration with Saviynt through a connector or API, allowing automatic account import, provisioning, and reconciliation.
Disconnected Application	An application that does not support direct integration with Saviynt. Access is managed manually or through file-based imports and exports.
Application Discovery	The process of identifying applications within an organization and collecting information such as application owner, type, users, and access details before onboarding them into Saviynt.
Integration Agent	A lightweight service installed inside an organization's network that enables Saviynt Cloud to securely communicate with on-premises applications without exposing them to the internet.
JDBC (Java Database Connectivity)	A connector used by Saviynt to connect to databases (Oracle, SQL Server, MySQL, PostgreSQL, etc.) for importing users, accounts, and provisioning access.
LDAP Connector	A connector used to integrate with LDAP-based directory services such as Active Directory or OpenLDAP for user import, account management, and provisioning.
REST Connector	A connector that communicates with applications using REST APIs over HTTP/HTTPS to perform account import, provisioning, and reconciliation.
SCIM (System for Cross-domain Identity Management)	An open standard used for automated user provisioning, deprovisioning, and identity synchronization between identity providers and cloud applications.
SAP	An enterprise resource planning (ERP) application commonly integrated with Saviynt for identity governance, account management, role assignment, and access certifications.

Salesforce

A cloud-based CRM application that can be integrated with Saviynt for automated user provisioning, account management, role assignment, and access governance.

ServiceNow

A cloud-based IT Service Management (ITSM) platform that integrates with Saviynt for user provisioning, account management, workflow automation, and governance.

Access Requests

Topic	Interview Definition
Access Request	The process by which a user requests access to an application, role, entitlement, or account through Saviynt. The request follows an approval workflow before provisioning.
New Access	A request to grant new access (application, role, entitlement, or account) that the user does not currently have.
Modify Access	A request to change existing access, such as adding or removing entitlements, changing roles, or updating account permissions.
Remove Access	A request to revoke or remove existing access that is no longer required. This can also happen automatically during deprovisioning or certification.
Self Request	An access request submitted by a user for their own access through the Saviynt Access Request Portal.
Manager Request	An access request submitted by a manager on behalf of one or more team members.
Admin Request	An access request submitted by an administrator for another user, usually for operational or support purposes.
Bulk Request	A single request used to grant, modify, or revoke access for multiple users at the same time, reducing manual effort.
Emergency Access	Temporary privileged access granted to a user during critical situations. The access usually has an approval process and an automatic expiration date.
JITA (Just-In-Time Access)	A security feature that provides temporary access only when it is needed. Access is automatically removed after the approved time period expires.
Request Cart	A temporary shopping cart where users can add multiple access requests before submitting them together for approval.
Checkout	The final step in the access request process where the user reviews the selected requests and submits them into the approval workflow.

Approval Workflow

Topic	Interview Definition
Workflow	A predefined business process in Saviynt that controls how access requests, approvals, certifications, and provisioning are processed.
Approval	The process where authorized approvers review and either approve or reject an access request before provisioning begins.
Approval Chain	The sequence of approvers through which an access request passes, such as Manager → Application Owner → Security Team.
Multi-Level Approval	An approval process that requires more than one approver before the request is provisioned.
Manager Approval	Approval provided by the requester's reporting manager to verify the business need for the requested access.
Owner Approval	Approval provided by the Application Owner, Role Owner, or Entitlement Owner to verify that the requested access is appropriate.
Auto Approval	A workflow configuration where requests meeting predefined conditions are automatically approved without manual intervention.
Rejection	The process of denying an access request. Once rejected, provisioning does not occur.
Escalation	Automatically forwarding a pending approval to another approver if it is not acted upon within a specified time.
Delegation	Temporarily assigning approval responsibilities to another user during absence, vacation, or leave.
SLA (Service Level Agreement)	The predefined time limit within which an approver or provisioning task must be completed. If exceeded, reminders or escalations may occur.

Email

Topic	Interview Definition
Email Template	A predefined email format used by Saviynt to send notifications for events such as access requests, approvals, provisioning, certifications, and password changes.
Email Notification	An automated email sent by Saviynt to inform users, managers, or administrators about events such as approvals, rejections, provisioning status, reminders, or certifications.
SMTP (Simple Mail Transfer Protocol)	The standard protocol used by Saviynt to send outgoing emails through a configured mail server.
Trigger	An event or action that causes Saviynt to send an email notification automatically, such as submitting an access request or completing provisioning.
Reminder	An automated email sent to approvers or reviewers reminding them to complete pending tasks before the due date.
Escalation Mail	An email automatically sent to a higher-level approver or administrator when an approval or certification task is not completed within the defined SLA.

AI & Recommendations

Topic	Interview Definition
Recommendations	Suggestions provided by Saviynt to help users or reviewers make better access decisions based on identity data, access history, and governance policies.
Intelligent Recommendations	AI-driven recommendations that analyze user behavior, peer access, roles, and historical decisions to recommend whether access should be granted or revoked.
Dynamic Peer Groups	Groups of users automatically created based on common attributes such as department, location, job title, or manager to compare access patterns.
Peer Analysis	The process of comparing a user's access with that of similar users to identify unusual or excessive access.
Similar Users	Users who share common characteristics (department, role, location, job title, etc.) and are used for comparison during recommendation analysis.
AI Engine	The artificial intelligence component in Saviynt that analyzes identity and access data to generate intelligent recommendations.
Recommendation Score	A numerical score generated by the AI Engine indicating the confidence level of an access recommendation. A higher score indicates greater confidence

Access Governance

Topic	Interview Definition
Certification	A periodic review process in which managers or application owners verify that users still require their assigned access.
Campaign	A collection of certification tasks created for a specific group of users, applications, roles, or entitlements during an access review.
Reviewer	The person responsible for reviewing and making certification decisions, such as a Manager, Application Owner, Role Owner, or Entitlement Owner.
Reviewer Decision	The action taken by the reviewer during certification, such as Approve, Revoke, Reassign, or Delegate.
Revoke	A certification decision that removes unnecessary or unauthorized access from a user.
Reassign	The process of sending a certification task to another reviewer who is better suited to review the access.
Delegate	Temporarily assigning certification responsibilities to another reviewer during absence or leave.
Expiration	The date and time after which a certification campaign or temporary access is automatically closed or expires.
Reminder	An automated notification sent to reviewers reminding them to complete pending certification tasks before the due date.
Escalation	Automatically forwarding pending certification tasks to another reviewer or administrator if they are not completed within the configured SLA.
Threshold	A configurable percentage or value used to determine campaign behavior, such as automatically completing or escalating a campaign when a defined level of completion is reached.

Policy & Risk

Topic	Interview Definition
Policy	A business or security rule in Saviynt that defines how user access should be governed, such as SoD policies, password policies, or access request policies.
Policy Engine	The Saviynt component that evaluates identities, roles, entitlements, and access requests against configured policies to detect violations or enforce governance rules.
Ruleset	A collection of related rules grouped together to evaluate a specific policy, such as multiple Segregation of Duties (SoD) checks.
Rule	An individual condition or logic used to validate user access or trigger actions. Example: "Finance users cannot have both Create Vendor and Approve Payment access."
SoD (Segregation of Duties)	A security control that prevents users from having conflicting access that could lead to fraud or security risks.
Risk Score	A numerical value assigned to a user, role, or entitlement that indicates the level of security or compliance risk associated with the access. Higher scores represent higher risk.
Mitigation	The process of reducing or controlling identified risks without immediately removing access, usually through additional approvals or compensating controls.
Exception	A temporary approval allowing a user to retain access that violates a policy or SoD rule for a valid business reason. Exceptions usually have an approval process and expiration date.

Jobs

Topic	Interview Definition
Job Control	The Saviynt module used to schedule, execute, monitor, retry, and manage background jobs.
Scheduler	The component that automatically runs jobs at predefined times or intervals.
Import Job	A background job that imports identities, accounts, entitlements, or application data into Saviynt.
Provisioning Job	A job that processes provisioning tasks and executes account creation, modification, or deletion in target systems.
Analytics Job	A job that generates reports, dashboards, metrics, and analytical data.
Cleanup Job	A maintenance job that removes old logs, completed tasks, temporary files, or unnecessary data to improve system performance.
Task Engine	The Saviynt service responsible for processing provisioning tasks from the task queue and communicating with connectors.
Run Job	The action of manually or automatically starting a scheduled job.
Stop Job	The process of stopping a currently running job if required for troubleshooting or maintenance.
Retry Job	Re-executing a failed job after correcting the issue that caused the failure.
Job History	A record of previously executed jobs, including execution time, status, duration, and results.
Job Logs	Detailed execution logs that record job activities, errors, warnings, and processing details for troubleshooting.

Analytics

Topic	Interview Definition
Analytics	The Saviynt feature used to search, analyze, monitor, and report identity and access information across the organization.
Reports	Predefined or custom outputs that display identity, access, certification, provisioning, and audit information for governance and compliance.
Dashboard	A visual interface that displays key identity governance metrics, charts, reports, and system health information in one place.
Saved Search	A frequently used search query that is saved for quick access without recreating the search each time.
Query	A search statement or condition used to retrieve specific identity or access information from Saviynt.
Filters	Conditions applied to narrow search results based on attributes such as application, department, manager, status, or location.
Metrics	Numerical measurements used to evaluate system performance, compliance, provisioning activity, certification progress, and governance effectiveness.
Audit Logs	Detailed records of user activities, configuration changes, approvals, provisioning events, and administrative actions used for auditing and troubleshooting.

Troubleshooting

Topic	Interview Definition
Troubleshooting	The process of identifying, analyzing, and resolving issues related to imports, provisioning, workflows, connectors, certifications, access requests, and system jobs in Saviynt.
Logs	Records generated by Saviynt that capture system events, job executions, provisioning activities, connector communication, and errors. Logs are the first place to check during troubleshooting.
Debug	A troubleshooting method used to identify the root cause of an issue by analyzing logs, configurations, job execution details, and connector responses.
Connector Logs	Logs that record communication between Saviynt and target applications (LDAP, REST, JDBC, SCIM, etc.), including requests, responses, and connector errors.
Job Logs	Detailed logs generated during job execution that show processing steps, execution status, warnings, and errors.
Error Codes	System-generated codes or messages that identify the reason for a failure, helping administrators quickly diagnose issues.
Provisioning Failure	A situation where Saviynt cannot create, modify, or remove access in a target application due to connector issues, invalid data, permission problems, or application errors.
Import Failure	A failure during User Import or Account Import caused by incorrect connector configuration, authentication failures, network issues, invalid mappings, or bad source data.
Mapping Issues	Errors caused by incorrect attribute mapping or account mapping between Saviynt and the source/target application.
Correlation Failure	A failure that occurs when Saviynt cannot match an imported account to an existing identity because the correlation attribute (Employee ID, Username, Email, etc.) does not match.
Workflow Failure	A failure in the approval workflow due to missing approvers, incorrect workflow configuration, invalid rules, or workflow execution errors.

Email Failure	Failure of email notifications caused by SMTP configuration issues, invalid recipient addresses, disabled email templates, or mail server connectivity problems.
Certification Issues	Problems during certification campaigns such as incorrect reviewers, missing campaigns, overdue reviews, escalation failures, or certification task errors.
Access Request Issues	Problems that prevent access requests from being submitted, approved, provisioned, or completed successfully due to workflow, policy, provisioning, or connector issues.